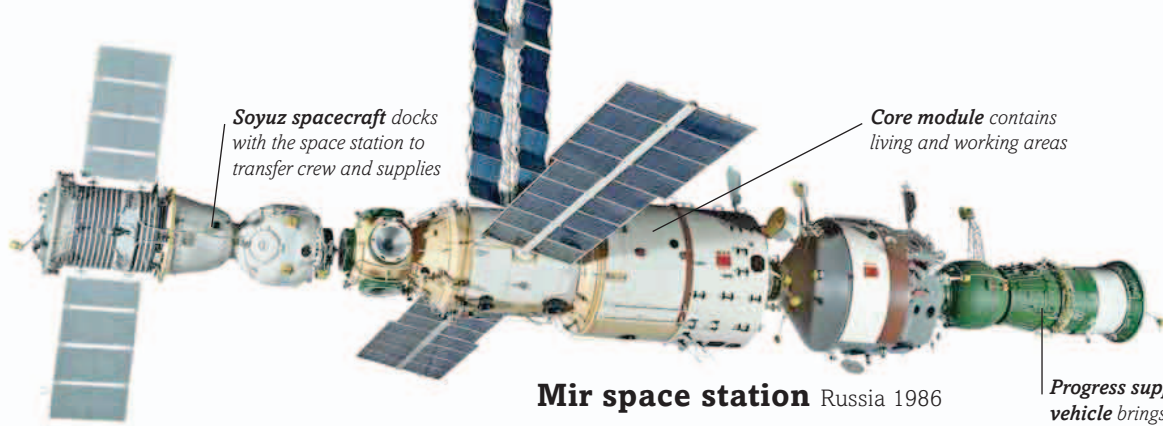




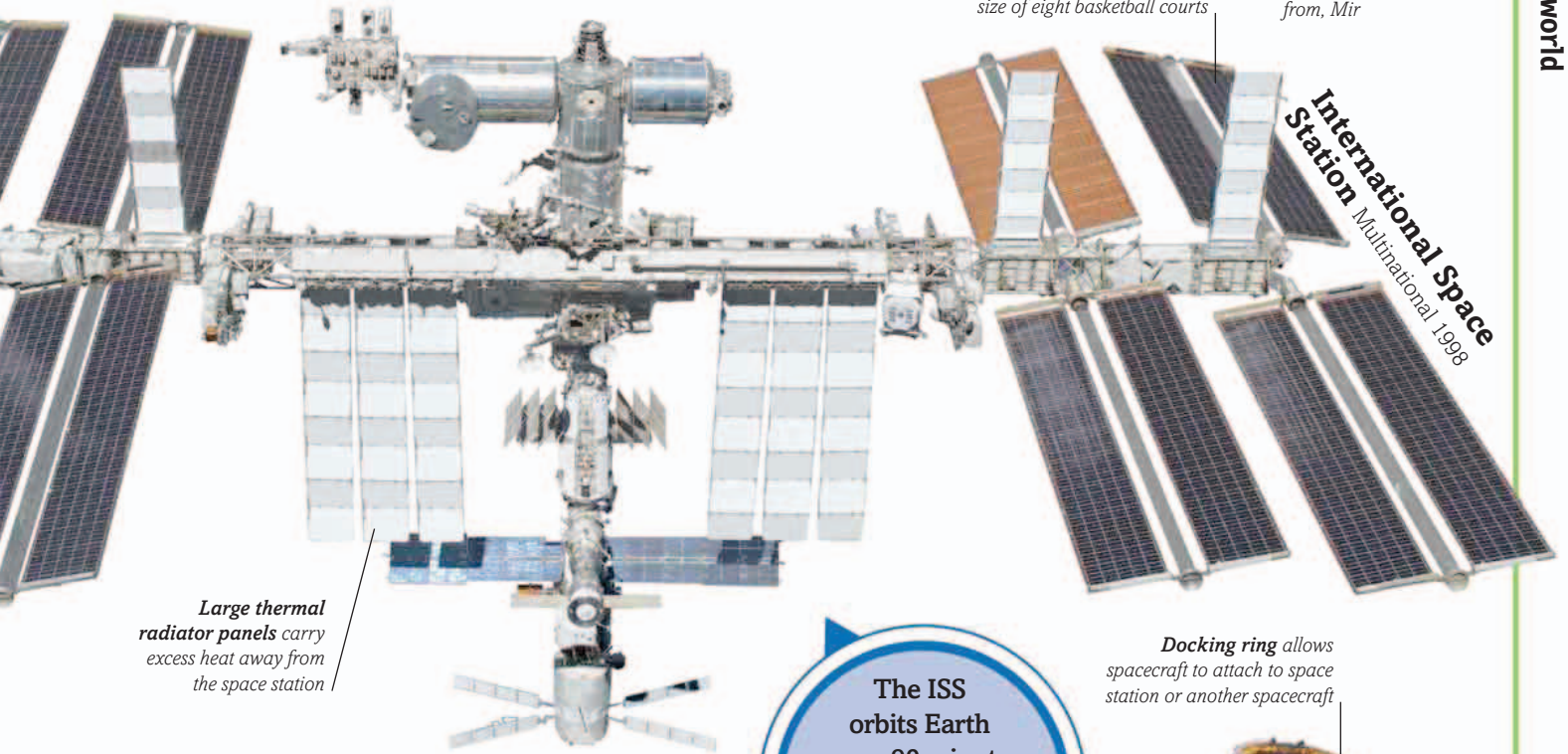
Soyuz spacecraft docks with the space station to transfer crew and supplies

Core module contains living and working areas

Mir space station Russia 1986

Progress supply vehicle brings materials to, and removed waste from, Mir

Solar panels cover an area the size of eight basketball courts



International Space Station Multinational 1998

Large thermal radiator panels carry excess heat away from the space station

Habitation module houses three astronauts

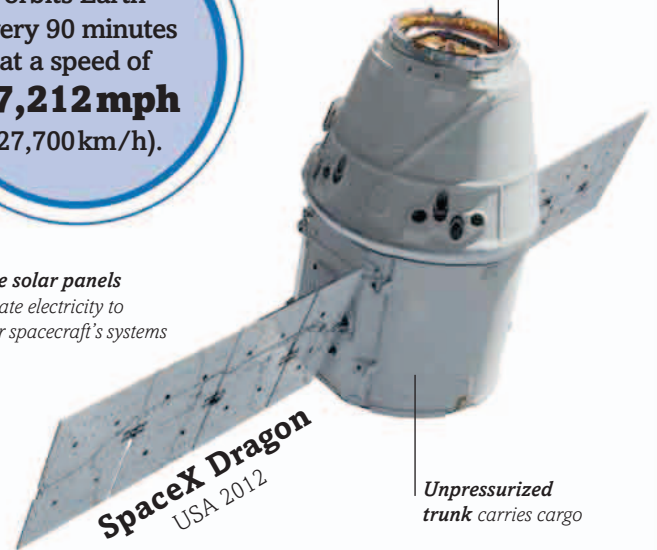
The ISS orbits Earth every 90 minutes at a speed of **17,212 mph** (27,700 km/h).

Docking ring allows spacecraft to attach to space station or another spacecraft

Large solar panels generate electricity to power spacecraft's systems



Shenzhou China 1999



SpaceX Dragon USA 2012

Unpressurized trunk carries cargo

Three crews, with three members in each, lived in the **Skylab** space station for a total of 171½ days, performing 300 experiments. Cosmonauts inhabited the **Mir Space Station** for 12½ years, with Valeri Polyakov spending a record-breaking 437 days, 18 hours in a row. Mir was the first

space station to be built from modules that were put together in space. The biggest space station to date is the **International Space Station** (ISS), which needed more than 100 spaceflights, and 1,000 hours of space walks, to assemble. It has been manned since 2000.